VON ZAROVICH ESTATE / STATION 4

The Mimic Menagerie

Four arches. Four keys. An uncomfortable silence.

The door seals behind you with a soft, final click. Dust and old lamp oil hang in the air. The room is round, its walls disappearing upward into purple-lit shadow.

Four stone arches stand along the far wall, numbered I, II, III, and IV in tarnished brass. Beneath each arch, a silver key with a wolf-shaped crest rests on a plain stone pedestal. The keys look exactly alike. So do the waiting pedestals.

A stone table stands back from the arches. Four wands rest in carved cradles: one shines with a sunlike crystal, one curls around a little serpent skull, one gleams green, and one ends in a ghostly sculpted hand. Their labels read Bright Light, Poison, Acid, and Mage Hand.

Brass studs form a line across the flagstones between the table and the arches. Along the walls, torch flames lean and straighten though you feel no breeze.

Nothing leaps out. Nothing growls. Nothing conveniently explains itself. The four silver keys simply wait, as if they have all the time in the world.

Behind you, the door handle refuses to turn.

What do you do? Talk with your partner. Tell the DM what you want to examine or try. Your character sheet may give you ideas.